prophetic legacy.[16] Self-styled philosophers like Judith Butler dubiously lay claim to the mantle of earlier German-Jewish thinkers such as Hermann Cohen, Martin Buber, Walter Benjamin, and Hannah Arendt—each in their different ways now manipulated in the service of the anti-Zionist cause. Jewish universalism and "cosmopolitanism" are once more in vogue—among the *bien-pensants*—in contrast to the "tribal nationalism" of Israel. The time is ripe for caricaturing the Jewish State as a benighted ethnocracy, the world's last remaining colonial settler-State or even as a Middle Eastern clone of the Third Reich.

One of the prime Jewish witnesses for the prosecution of Zionism in the postwar era is Hannah Arendt. The then little-known German-Jewish intellectual who escaped to the United States in 1942, initially identified with the Zionist movement as the only effective Jewish *political* response to Nazi antisemitism. But by 1945 at the latest, when Arendt published her vitriolic essay "Zionism Reconsidered" (which *Commentary* turned down for having "too many anti-semitic implications"), she was profoundly disillusioned by the movement.[17] Arendt attacked the Zionist leadership for allegedly seeking a homogeneous Jewish State, for producing a new category of Arab refugees in 1948, and relying on outside Big Powers as allies. But more than policy was involved. Arendt was opposed *in principle* to a Jewish nation-state and Jewish political sovereignty in Palestine, feeling closer to the binational solution proposed by Judah Magnes, the first president of the Hebrew University and guiding leader of the pre-state peace movement, Brit Shalom.

Arendt foresaw that the upbuilding of a Jewish State in Palestine would not end international antisemitism. She was especially critical of the allegedly Zionist belief "that all Gentiles are anti-Semitic, and everybody and everything is against the Jews."[18] This was, in her view, one of the lynchpins of the "blind chauvinism" of the Zionists. But after 1948, Arendt would withdraw from all overtly political activity though her correspondence and the publication of *Eichmann in Jerusalem* (1963) exposed a highly antagonistic attitude to Israel. As a result of her Eichmann book, Arendt was accused of heartlessness in seeming to blame the Jewish Council leaders (*Judenräte*) for the Nazi mass murder of European Jewry, for being latently antisemitic in tone, and even trivializing the Holocaust.[19] Most of these charges were exaggerated though they contained a grain of truth. However, Arendt never specifically defined herself as an anti-Zionist, but rather as a dissenting member of the "loyal opposition."[20] This definition, however problematic, has been forgotten by the Jewish and Israeli anti-Zionists of our time, who invoke her name to legitimize their own radical animosity to Israel.

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